Department of Energy
Washington, DC 20585

July 27, 2015

REQUEST FOR QUOTATION (RFQ) NUMBER DE-SOL-0008751

TO ALL INTERESTED PERSONS:

The U.S. Department of Energy (DOE) has a requirement to design, develop, and launch an innovative and interactive website that profiles women scientists, researchers and leaders employed at DOE National Laboratories. The work defined for this requirement is directly related to DOE's mission of supporting Science Technology Engineering and Mathematics (STEM) education and workforce development. Specifically, the website design and development efforts outlined in the Statement of Work are in support of a Women@Energy (W@E) book initiative that is targeted towards middle-school girls and teachers within the U.S. public school system to build awareness and promote the educational and career opportunities undertaken by DOE's women scientist, researchers, and leaders in hopes of inspiring young girls to consider exploring STEM related educational and/or careers opportunities.

There will only be one award as a result of this solicitation. This award will be awarded on a "Best Value" basis, based on the attached Evaluation/Selection Criteria. The award will be a firm fixed price purchase order. All work must be in accordance with the specifications listed in the attached Statement of Work (SOW).

In order to be eligible for this award the offeror must be a small business under NAICS code 541511 "Custom Computer Programming Services". The size standard in millions of dollars for NAICS code 541511 is $27.5.

Offerors shall complete the following blocks on the SF18; Blocks 11 and 13 through 16 of the RFQ.

All offerors are solely responsible for all bid and quote/proposal costs associated with their proposal.

Vendors will be required to submit a price proposal via FedConnect at https://www.fedconnect.net/fedconnect/. **You must use FEDCONNECT to submit your quote.**

Vendors must register via the FedConnect website prior to submitting proposals. Instructions on how to submit your proposal electronically can be found in the help document, which is located under the "Have questions? Need help getting started?" button on the FedConnect website. Additional technical assistance can be obtained by emailing the Help Desk personnel at support@fedconnect.net or 1-800-899-6665.

Proposals must be received through the FedConnect website NO LATER THAN 3:00 PM local prevailing time (Washington, DC) on August 3, 2015. Your quote should be valid for 30

calendar days.

The Department's designated point of contact for this RFQ is Bernard Watts. Proposals must not be sent to the e-mail address. Proposals submitted to the e-mail address will be rejected as non-responsive. You are cautioned to contact only Mr. Watts concerning this RFQ until after contract award. It is requested that all communications with Mr. Watts be in writing.

Questions concerning this solicitation must be submitted no later than 12:00PM on July 29, 2015.

Albert A. Manley
Contracting Officer
Office of Headquarters Procurement Services

Attachments:
1. SF-18
2. Statement of Work
3. Evaluation Criteria

STATEMENT OF WORK
OFFICE OF ECONOMIC IMPACT AND DIVERSITY
WOMEN@ENERGY – WEB DESIGN AND DEVELOPMENT PROJECT

I. AGENCY MISSION

The Department of Energy (DOE), Office of Economic Impact and Diversity (ED), advocates to increase the engagement of minority communities in the energy sector pursuant to statutory mandate and in full support of the Secretary of Energy's commitment to the President to create an Agency that cultivates and promotes a diverse American workforce to build our economy. DOE helps drive energy technology and policy to meet the demands and challenges that face our nation. ED supports and administers Presidential/Secretarial priorities through the Minorities in Energy Initiative, including the Climate Action Plan, job-driven skills training, Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics (STEM) education, and place-based economic initiatives. The Agency supports specific White House initiatives, including Executive Order 13583, to promote diversity and inclusion in the federal workforce, My Brother's Keeper, White House Council on Women and Girls, White House Initiatives in support of Minority and Tribal Education, Minority Serving Institutions, and designated minority communities and businesses.

The work defined for this requirement is directly related to DOE's mission of supporting STEM education and workforce development. Specifically, the website design and development efforts outlined in this request are in support of a Women@Energy (W@E) book initiative that is targeted towards middle-school girls and teachers within the U.S. public school system to build awareness and promote the educational and career opportunities undertaken by DOE's women scientist, researchers, and leaders in hopes of inspiring young girls to consider exploring STEM related educational and/or careers opportunities.

ED seeks a Contractor to design, develop, and launch an innovative and interactive website that profiles women scientists, researchers and leaders employed at DOE National Laboratories within a creative and engaging manner. The website must be designed with the following attributes:

- Enterprise architecture-compliant
- Ability to be easily integrated into the existing DOE corporate website
- Cost-effective IT solutions that increase efficiency, reduce data entry, reduce IT system and operations costs
- Scalable to incorporate future web enhancements and/or applications

II. CURRENT ENVIRONMENT

DOE currently uses a limited version of Drupal's Content Management System which does not adequately supports the creative and interactive modules needed to provide a rich and engaging user experience, navigation, and dynamic look and feel that is appealing to web savvy youths.

III. SCOPE

The scope, milestones and deliverable requirements will be implemented and thoroughly identified in task assignments issued post award This task order will be performed for a three-year period with one base period, and two option years.

The Contractor shall provide requirements management, project management, change control management and testing during the Design/Development/Enhancement efforts to ensure:

- Deployment of high-quality code that accurately meets the requirements successful releases without introduction of unexpected problems;
- Minimal need for emergency/corrective maintenance;
- Minimal need to fix the same issue multiple times; and
- Maximum value out of limited IT budget resources

The Contractor shall support the following functions:

- **Website and Content Management System Design and Development** – Tasks will includes requirement analysis, design, development, testing, and deployment of changes and enhancements to engender new or modified functionality in response to DOE, ED, and/or stakeholder needs. All of these services will include coordination with the infrastructure support vendor(s) and, from the Contractor's side, effective project management in alignment with Project Planning and Management (PPM) process.

- **Content Integration and Optimization** – Tasks will includes the creation and integration of text and images into the website in a uniformed manner with a consistent look-and-feel throughout, including content pages/templates/modules, etc. The ability to incorporate/apply Search Engine Optimization (SEO) and Search Engine Marketing (SEM) standards into the website. Keyword tags will be integrated throughout page titles, descriptions, and sub headings to enable keyword density, cross-page linking and the proper indexing of site content.

- **Customized Content Development and Integration** – Tasks will includes, but not limited to, the creation, development and/or publishing of customized videos, blogs, in-app STEM content, location-based activity listings, enhanced, iconic, profile personas, classroom/"at home" experiments, etc. . .

- **User Acceptance Testing** - The Contractor must prepare a User Acceptance Test (UAT) plan and test scenarios/scripts for users to follow during the initial structured portion of the UAT (following structured testing the users are encouraged to conduct their own free-form testing). The Contractor shall assist ED during the preparation and execution of the acceptance test by establishing test data and maintaining the test environment. The Contractor shall provide the draft version of all documentation, including the Requirements Traceability Matrix (RTM), which shall be delivered with the final product at the time of the initiation of the UAT period. The RTM shall clearly link the new and/or changed requirements to where and how they have been implemented in the system, to assist the users during testing. The Contractor shall correct any errors identified by the UAT team and DOE. The Contractor shall document the results of the testing in a Test Report. Upon receipt of the report, ED will examine the test results and make a determination as to the readiness of the new or modified systems' code and/or database changes/additions to be released into the production environment. ED will certify the planned release under one of the following categories:

  1) It is virtually error free and should be released into production;

  2) If errors still exist that should be addressed, however, a decision could be made that either: a) The release can proceed intact and the errors will be corrected and implemented through a subsequent release or, b) The release can proceed but the portions determined defective will be removed from it and errors will be corrected and implemented through a subsequent release. It has major shortcomings and should not be released into production at this time. Instead, it should be returned for further development and re-testing.

- **Quality Assurance & Deployment** - The Contractor must provide a Quality Assurance Plan (QAP) that conforms to the minimum standards as identified in the Quality Assurance guidelines identified in the PPM. The Contractor shall identify a team that is dedicated to Quality Assurance and ensure that only high quality products and services are delivered to the Government. The Contractor shall maintain a Lessons Learned document, updating it subsequent to each release, and as required by PPM process. The Contractor shall disseminate lessons learned to the team after each release, and make recommendations as appropriate to ED to increase the quality of future deliverables and improve reliability and efficiency of systems.

- **Training and Documentation** - The Contractor must develop new documents, or update existing documents, as specified in the task assignments. Examples of standard documents that will be created or updated include: Requirements Definition Document; Solution Architecture Document; Technical Design Document; Interface Control Document and/or Interconnection Security Agreement; Test Plan; Release Plan; Communication Plan; Staffing Management Plan; Capacity Plan; Data Conversion Plan; Test Report; Operations and Maintenance Manual; Project Completion Report; Post Deployment Report; etc. . .

- **Project Management** - All technical direction shall be initiated via a task assignment and will follow the Project Planning and Management (PPM) process. Some or all of the project phases defined by PPM will be included in the Project Plan. The project plan will identify the milestones phases, including but not limited to, design, development, deployment, and maintenance. It will also include milestones for requirements gathering/business process analysis meetings, agile development design sessions, prototype demonstrations, regular status meetings, and other meetings as necessary where the Contractor needs input from the Government or staff requests demonstration of functionality. The project plan will also provide a schedule for all PPM and other deliverables identified in the task assignment as well as any of the following based on the scope of the change or the Level of Effort (LOE), as required by the Government.

  ED will closely monitor the cost and schedule of the task assignments to minimize potential for cost and/or schedule variance. The Government encourages the Contractor to follow the work process flow, methodology, procedures, deliverables and best practices that conform to the standards dictated by the Project Management Body of Knowledge (PMBOK) Guide, Project Management Life Cycle defined and published by the Project Management Institute (PMI).

  - Change Management (CM): The Contractor must identify and define steps for initiating software changes that may alter business requirements. The Contractor will maintain a Change Control Register (CCR) for each system to log and track all change requests and requests to implement new requirements.
  - Release Management: The Contractor must establish and identify specific processes to manage the risks associated with each release and to addresses the coordination and responsibilities of all functional areas affected by a release.
  - Problem Tracking: The Contractor must thoroughly track issues and submit them to the Change Control Board for evaluation and approval of the proposed resolutions.
  - Change Management Tools: The Contractor will use standard CM tools as part of the CM process.

Women@Energy Website Design - Evaluation Criteria

Basis for Award

Selection of an Offeror to perform the work will be based on a "best value" selection, meaning the expected outcome of an acquisition that, in the Government's estimation, provides the greatest overall benefit in response to the requirements. The evaluation and selection will be based on the following criteria, listed in descending order of importance: Technical Approach, Personnel Capability, and Past Performance. The technical factors collectively are more important than price. The Government will utilize an adjectival rating system (Excellent, good, marginal, and unacceptable).

Technical Approach

The Offeror will be evaluated on their understanding of the requirements of the Statement of Work and how your technical solution supports the broad objectives of this project.

The Offeror will be evaluated on the proposed approach to the conceptual design for the total requirement, your compliance to system's specifications, the anticipated performance levels and realism of your proposed schedule.

The Offeror will be evaluated on the demonstrated understanding and working knowledge of: open source platforms, Drupal in particular; video and graphic based content; search engine optimization; search engine marketing; social media integration; K-12 STEM education content creation, messaging and positioning.

Personnel Capability

The Project Manager and project team members will be evaluated on their knowledge and understanding of the K-12 audience, teachers, and key influencers/organizations focused on STEM.

The Project Manager and project team members will be evaluated on their demonstrated experience in partnering with major corporations, federal agencies, state and local government and/or non-profit organizations to deliver and implement K-12 STEM education and outreach solutions.

Past Performance

The evaluation team will consider if the past performance relevant contracts/projects of similar nature, scope and complexity as they relate to the Statement of Work. Relevant and recent experience with website design and content creation in support of STEM education and outreach will be evaluated more favorably.

Best Value Features

Proficient in Drupal. The quality of the website design, development, and performance analytic solutions.

Deep experience in K-12 STEM education and outreach with proven success in partnering with federal agencies, state and local governments, non-profit organization and large corporations to deliver and implement STEM tools and/or products/services.